(h) Words expressing nearness in time or place are generally changed into words expressing distance. Thus:-

now	→	then
here	→	there
ago	→	before
thus	→	so
today	→	that day
tomorrow	→	the next day
yesterday	→	the day before
last night	→	the night before

Direct - The Prince said, "It gives me great pleasure to be here this evening."

Indirect - The Prince said that it gave him great pleasure to be there that evening.

(i) The changes do not occur if the speech is reported during the same period or at the same place.

Direct - The Prince said, "It gives me great pleasure to be here this evening."

Indirect - The Prince said that it gives him great pleasure to be here this evening.

Questions

In reporting questions the Indirect Speech is introduced by some verbs as asked, enquired, whether or if etc.

Direct - He said to me, "What are you doing?"

Indirect - He asked me what I was doing.

8th_english_4 to 6.indd 166 1/25/2021 3:52:40 PM